

Chapter 6

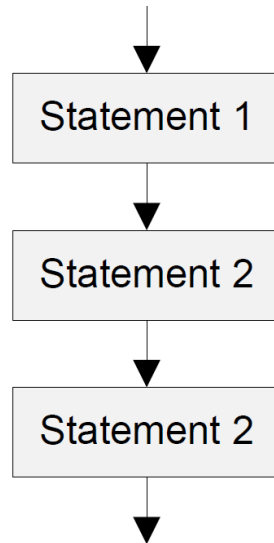
Control Flow in Assembly

Z. Gu

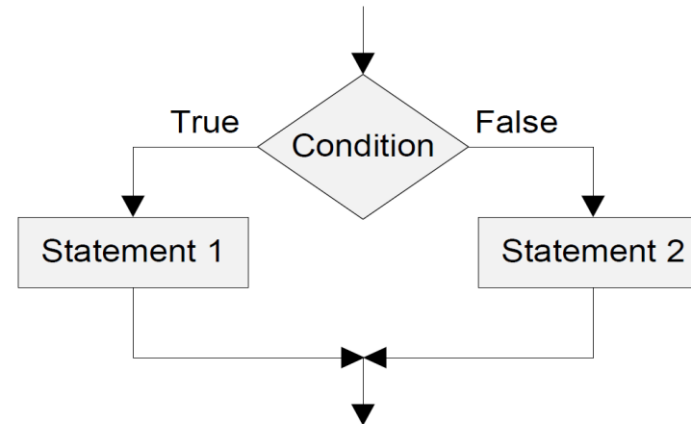
Fall 2025

Three Control Structures

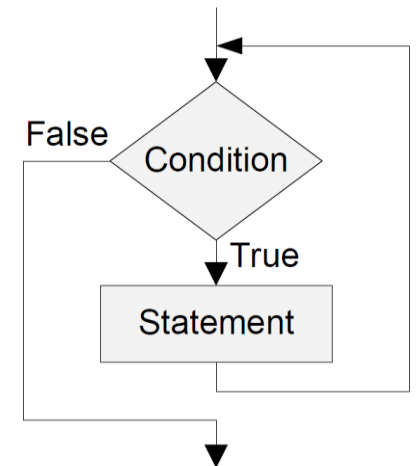
- ▶ **Sequence Structure**
 - ▶ Computer executes statements (instructions), one after another, in the order listed in the program
- ▶ **Selection Structure**
 - ▶ **If-then-else**
- ▶ **Loop Structure**
 - ▶ **while loop**
 - ▶ **for loop**



Sequence Structure

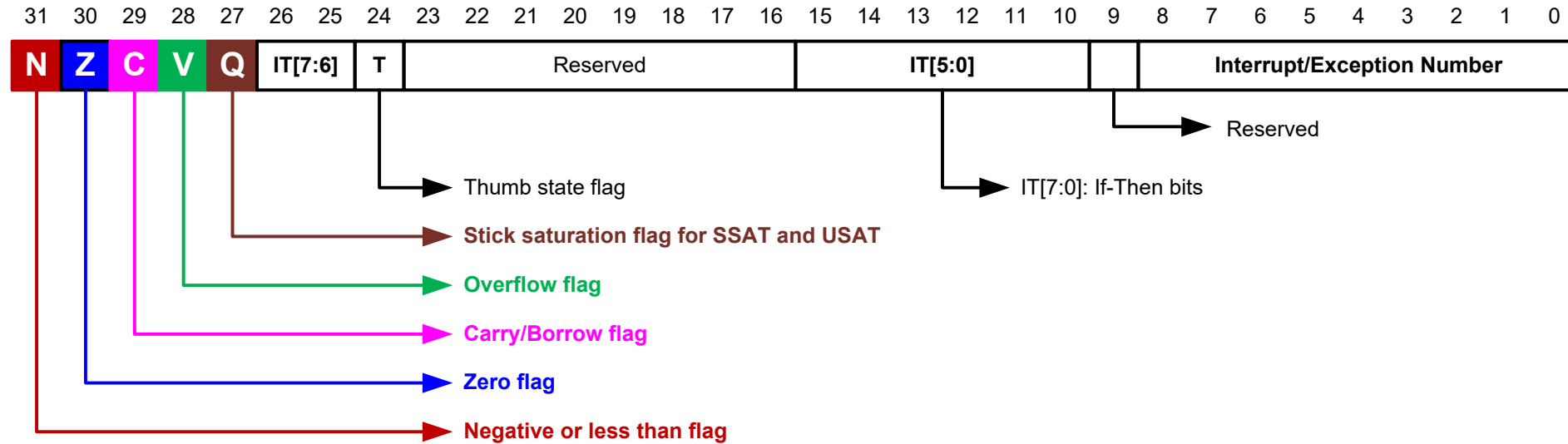


Selection Structure



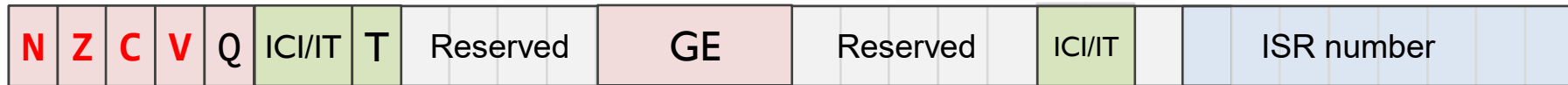
Loop Structure

Combined Program Status Registers (xPSR)



Condition Flags

Program Status Register (PSR)



► **Negative** bit

- N = 1 if most significant bit of result is 1

► **Zero** bit

- Z = 1 if all bits of result are 0

► **Carry** bit

- For unsigned addition, C = 1 if carry takes place
- For unsigned subtraction, C = 0 (carry = not borrow) if borrow takes place
- For shift/rotation, C = last bit shifted out

► **oVerflow** bit

- V = 1 if adding 2 same-signed numbers produces a result with the opposite sign
 - Positive + Positive = Negative, or
 - Negative + negative = Positive
- Non-arithmetic operations does not touch V bit, such as MOV, AND, LSL, MUL

Negative -----

signed result is negative

Zero -----

result is 0

Carry -----

add op → overflow

sub op doesn't borrow

last bit shifted out when shifting

oVerflow ---

add/sub op → signed overflow

Carry and Overflow Flags w/ Arithmetic Instructions

Carry flag $C = 1$ (Borrow flag = 0) upon an **unsigned** addition if the answer is wrong (true result $> 2^n - 1$)

Carry flag $C = 0$ (Borrow flag = 1) upon an **unsigned** subtraction if the answer is wrong (true result < 0)

Overflow flag $V = 1$ upon a **signed** addition or subtraction if the answer is wrong (true result $> 2^{n-1} - 1$ or true result $< -2^{n-1}$)

Overflow may occur when adding 2 operands with the same sign, or subtracting 2 operands with different signs; Overflow cannot occur when adding 2 operands with different signs or when subtracting 2 operands with the same sign.

	Unsigned Addition	Unsigned Subtraction	Signed Addition or Subtraction
Carry flag	true result $> 2^n - 1 \rightarrow$ Carry flag = 1 Borrow flag = 0 (Result incorrect)	true result $< 0 \rightarrow$ Carry flag = 0 Borrow flag = 1 (Result incorrect)	N/A
Overflow flag	N/A	N/A	true result $> 2^{n-1} - 1$ or true result $< -2^{n-1}$ $\rightarrow$ Overflow flag = 1 (Result incorrect)

Updating Condition Flags

- ▶ Method 1: append “**S**”: updates destination register, and sets flags
 - ▶ `ADD r0,r1,r2` → `ADDS r0,r1,r2`
 - ▶ `SUB r0,r1,r2` → `SUBS r0,r1,r2`
 - ▶ Performs operation, writes the result into Rd, and also updates NZCV flags
- ▶ Method 2: compare instructions: sets flags only
 - ▶ `CMP/CMN/TEQ/TST`: performs operation to update NZCV flags, but the computation result is not saved and discarded

Instruction	Description	Flags
CMP	Compare	N,Z,C,V
CMN	Compare Negative	N,Z,C,V
TEQ	Test Equivalence	N,Z,C
TST	Test	N,Z,C

Updating Condition Flags

Instruction	Operands	Brief description	Flags
CMP	Rn, Op2	Compare	N,Z,C,V
CMN	Rn, Op2	Compare Negative	N,Z,C,V
TEQ	Rn, Op2	Test Equivalence	N,Z,C
TST	Rn, Op2	Test	N,Z,C

➤ Update flags

- No need to add S. No need to specify destination register.

➤ Operations are:

- **CMP** Rn - Op2: Same as SUBS, except result discarded (not written to destination register)
- **CMN** Rn + Op2: Same as ADDS, except result discarded
- **TST** Rn & Op2: Same as ANDS, except result discarded
- **TEQ** Rn ^ Op2: Same as EORS, except result discarded

➤ Examples:

- **CMP** r0, r1
- **TST** r2, #5

Example of CMP

$$f(x) = |x|$$

```
Area absolute, CODE, READONLY
EXPORT __main
ENTRY

__main PROC
    CMP    r1, #0          ; r1 = x
    RSBLT  r0, r1, #0
done     B done            ; deadlock, end of program

    ENDP
END
```

RSBLT r1, r1, #0:: conditional execution of the RSB instruction with condition code LT. If $r1 < 0$, then set $r1 = -r1$

Updating Condition Flags: TST and TEQ

TST Rn, Operand2 ; Bitwise AND

TEQ Rn, Operand2 ; Bitwise Exclusive OR

- ▶ Update N and Z according to the result
- ▶ Can update C during the calculation of Operand2 (w/ shifting)
- ▶ Do not affect V
- ▶ TST performs **bitwise AND** on Rn and Operand2.
 - ▶ Same as ANDS, except result discarded.
 - ▶ Use Operand2 as a mask; Z=0 implies “some masked bit(s) are set, so result is non-zero”
Z=1 implies “none of the masked bit(s) are set, so result is zero.” For a single-bit mask,
Z=0 means “that bit in Rn is 1,” and Z=1 means “that bit is 0.”
- ▶ TEQ performs **bitwise Exclusive OR** on Rn and Operand2.
 - ▶ Same as EORS, except result discarded.
 - ▶ If Rn and Operand2 are equal, then $Rn \oplus Operand2$ is zero, and Z is set to 1; otherwise Z is cleared.

x	y	x AND y
0	0	0
0	1	0
1	0	0
1	1	1

x	y	x XOR y
0	0	0
0	1	1
1	0	1
1	1	0

Example of TEQ

- ▶ Translate C code into assembly:

C Code	Assembly
if (char=='!' char=='?') found++;	TEQ r0, #'!' TEQNE r0, #'?' ADDEQ r1, r1, #1

- ▶ TEQ r0, #'!' performs a test-equal by computing $r0 \oplus ' ! '$ and setting condition flags; Z=1 when r0 equals '!'.
- ▶ TEQNE r0, #'?' executes only if the previous Z=0 (i.e., char was not '!'); it tests r0 against '?' and sets Z accordingly. This achieves the logical OR without branches by conditionally running the second test only when needed.
 - ▶ Logical OR operator (||) employs short-circuit evaluation, meaning it evaluates expressions from left to right and stops as soon as the result of the entire expression is determined. For (cond1||cond2): If cond1 evaluates to true (non-zero), the overall result of the || operation is already known to be true, so cond2 is not evaluated. If cond1 evaluates to false (zero), the evaluation proceeds to the next operand cond2.
- ▶ ADDEQ r1, r1, #1 executes only if Z=1 after the tests, meaning char matched either '!' or '?'.

Unconditional Branch Instructions

Instruction	Operands	Brief description
B	label	Branch
BL	label	Branch with Link
BLX	Rm	Branch indirect with Link
BX	Rm	Branch indirect

- ▶ **B label**
 - ▶ cause a branch to label.
- ▶ **BL label**
 - ▶ copy the address of the next instruction into r14 (lr, the link register), and
 - ▶ cause a branch to label.
- ▶ **BX Rm**
 - ▶ branch to the address held in Rm
- ▶ **BLX Rm:**
 - ▶ copy the address of the next instruction into r14 (lr, the link register) and
 - ▶ branch to the address held in Rm

Unconditional Branch Instructions: A Simple Example

```
MOVS r1, #1
B target ; Branch to target
MOVS r2, #2 ; Not executed
MOVS r3, #3 ; Not executed
MOVS r4, #4 ; Not executed
target MOVS r5, #5
```

- ▶ A **label** marks the location of an instruction
- ▶ Labels helps human to read the code
- ▶ In machine program, labels are converted to numeric offsets by assembler

Signed vs. Unsigned Comparison

Conditional codes applied to
branch instructions

Compare	Signed	Unsigned
>	GT	HI
≥	GE	HS
<	LT	LO
≤	LE	LS
==	EQ	
≠	NE	



Compare	Signed	Unsigned
>	BGT	BHI
≥	BGE	BHS
<	BLT	BLO
≤	BLE	BLS
==	BEQ	
!=	BNE	

Branch Instructions

	Instruction	Description	Flags tested
Unconditional Branch	B <i>Label</i>	Branch to label	
Conditional Branch	BEQ <i>Label</i>	Branch if E Qual	Z = 1
	BNE <i>Label</i>	Branch if N ot E qual	Z = 0
	BCS/BHS <i>Label</i>	Branch if unsigned H igher or S ame	C = 1
	BCC/BLO <i>Label</i>	Branch if unsigned L ower	C = 0
	BMI <i>Label</i>	Branch if M inus (Negative)	N = 1
	BPL <i>Label</i>	Branch if P lus (Positive or Zero)	N = 0
	BVS <i>Label</i>	Branch if o V erflow S et	V = 1
	BVC <i>Label</i>	Branch if o V erflow C lear	V = 0
	BHI <i>Label</i>	Branch if unsigned H igher	C = 1 & Z = 0
	BLS <i>Label</i>	Branch if unsigned L ower or S ame	C = 0 or Z = 1
	BGE <i>Label</i>	Branch if signed G reater or E qual	N = V
	BLT <i>Label</i>	Branch if signed L ess T han	N != V
	BGT <i>Label</i>	Branch if signed G reater T han	Z = 0 & N = V
	BLE <i>Label</i>	Branch if signed L ess than or E qual	Z = 1 or N = ! V

Condition Codes

- ▶ The possible condition codes are listed below:

Suffix	Description	Flags tested
EQ	EQual	Z==1
NE	Not EQual	Z==0
CS/HS	Unsigned Higher or Same	C==1
CC/LO	Unsigned LOwer	C==0
MI	MInus (Negative)	N==1
PL	PLus (Positive or Zero)	N==0
VS	oVerflow Set	V==1
VC	oVerflow Clear	V==0
HI	Unsigned HIgher	C==1 and Z==0
LS	Unsigned Lower or Same	C==0 or Z==1
GE	Signed Greater or Equal	N==V
LT	Signed Less Than	N!=V
GT	Signed Greater Than	Z==0 and N==V
LE	Signed Less than or Equal	Z==1 or N!=V
AL	ALways	

Note AL is the default and does not need to be specified

Signed Comparison

CMP r0, r1

perform subtraction $r0 - r1$, without saving the result

	N = 0	N = 1
V = 0	- No overflow, implying the result is correct. - The result is non-negative, - Thus $r0 - r1 \geq 0$, i.e., $r0 \geq r1$	- No overflow, implying the result is correct. - The result is negative. - Thus $r0 - r1 < 0$, i.e., $r0 < r1$
V = 1	- Overflow occurs, implying the result is incorrect. - The result is mistakenly reported as non-negative and in fact it should be negative. - Thus $r0 - r1 < 0$ in reality, i.e., $r0 < r1$	- Overflow occurs, implying the result is incorrect. - The result is mistakenly reported as negative and in fact it should be non-negative. - Thus $r0 - r1 \geq 0$ in reality, i.e. $r0 \geq r1$

Conclusions:

- If $N == V$, then it is signed greater or equal (GE).
- Otherwise, it is signed less than (LT)

Signed Comparison

CMP r0, r1

perform subtraction $r0 - r1$, without saving the result

	N = 0	N = 1
V = 0	$r0 \geq r1$ CMP returns 1	$r0 < r1$ CMP returns 0
V = 1	$r0 < r1$ CMP returns 0	$r0 \geq r1$ CMP returns 1

Conclusions:

- If $N == V$, then it is signed greater or equal (GE).
- Otherwise, it is signed less than (LT)

Signed Comparison Example

CMP r0, r1

perform subtraction $r0 - r1$, without saving the result

	N = 0	N = 1
V = 0	• $r0 = +7$ (00111) • $r1 = +3$ (00011) • $r0 - r1 = +4$ (00100); • result non-negative and no signed overflow, so $N=0, V=0 \Rightarrow$ GE holds	• $r0 = +3$ (00011) • $r1 = +7$ (00111) • $r0 - r1 = -4$ (11100) • result negative with no overflow, so $N=1, V=0 \Rightarrow$ LT holds
V = 1	• $r0 = -10$ (10110) • $r1 = +7$ (00111) • $r0 - r1 = -17$, outside range $[-16, +15]$; result is 00111 (decimal 7), whose sign bit is 0 so $N=0$, but signed overflow occurs so $V=1 \Rightarrow$ LT holds	• $r0 = +10$ (01010) • $r1 = -7$ (11001) • $r0 - r1 = +17$, outside range $[-16, +15]$; result is 10001 (decimal -15), whose sign bit is 1 so $N=1$, but signed overflow occurs so $V=1 \Rightarrow$ GE holds

Conclusions:

- If $N == V$, then it is signed greater or equal (GE).
- Otherwise, it is signed less than (LT)

Signed vs. Unsigned Comparison

Conditional codes applied to
branch instructions

Compare	Signed	Unsigned
>	GT	HI
≥	GE	HS
<	LT	LO
≤	LE	LS
==	EQ	
≠	NE	



Compare	Signed	Unsigned
>	BGT	BHI
≥	BGE	BHS
<	BLT	BLO
≤	BLE	BLS
==	BEQ	
!=	BNE	

Number Interpretation

Which is greater?

0xFFFFFFFF or **0x00000001**

- ▶ If they represent signed numbers, the latter is greater.
(1 > -1).
- ▶ If they represent unsigned numbers, the former is greater
($2^{32}-1$ > 1).

Which is Greater: 0xFFFFFFFF or 0x00000001?

It's **software's responsibility** to tell computer how to interpret data:

- If written in C, declare the signed vs unsigned variable
- If written in Assembly, use signed vs unsigned branch instructions

```
int32_t x, y ;  
x = -1;  
y = 1;  
if (x > y)  
    ...
```

```
MOV r5, #0xFFFFFFFF  
MOV r6, #0x00000001  
CMP r5, r6  
BLE Then_Clause  
...
```

BLE: Branch if less than or equal, signed $\leq$

```
uint32_t x, y ;  
x = 4294967295;  
y = 1;  
if (x > y)  
    ...
```

```
MOV r5, #0xFFFFFFFF  
MOV r6, #0x00000001  
CMP r5, r6  
BLS Then_Clause  
...
```

BLS: Branch if lower or same, unsigned $\leq$

If-then Statement

C Program	Assembly Program 1	Assembly Program 2
<pre>// a is signed integer if (a < 0) { a = 0 - a; } x = x + 1;</pre>	<pre>; r1 = a (signed integer), r2 = x CMP r1, #0 ; Compare a with 0 BGE endif ; Go to endif if a ≥ 0 RSB r1, r1, #0 ; a = - a endif: ADD r2, r2, #1 ; x = x + 1</pre>	<pre>; r1 = a, r2 = x CMP r1, #0 RSBLT r1, r1, #0 ; a = - a if a < 0 ADD r2, r2, #1 ; x = x + 1</pre>

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>// x is a signed integer if(x <= 20 x >= 25){ a = 1 }</pre>	<pre>; r0 = x CMP r0, #20 ; compare x and 20 BLE then ; go to then if x ≤ 20 CMP r0, #25 ; compare x and 25 BLT endif ; go to endif if x < 25 then MOV r1, #1 ; a = 1 endif</pre>

If-then-else

C Program	Assembly Program 1
<pre>// a is signed integer if (a == 1) b = 3; else b = 4;</pre>	<pre>; r1 = a, r2 = b CMP r1, #1 ; compare a and 1 BNE else ; go to else if a ≠ 1 then: MOV r2, #3 ; b = 3 B endif ; go to endif else: MOV r2, #4 ; b = 4 endif:</pre>

For Loop

C Program

```
int i;  
int sum = 0;  
for(i = 0; i < 10; i++){  
    sum += i;  
}
```

C Program (equivalent)

```
int i = 0;  
int sum = 0;  
  
while (i < 10) {  
    sum += i;  
    i++;  
}
```

Implementation I (Classic compare-and-branch):

MOV	r0, #0	% sum = 0
MOV	r1, #0	% i = 0
loop:		
CMP	r1, #10	% i < 10 ?
BGE	done	% exit if i >= 10
ADD	r0, r0, r1	% sum += i
ADD	r1, r1, #1	% i++
B	loop	
done:		% : is optional after a label

For Loop

C Program

```
int i;  
int sum = 0;  
for(i = 0; i < 10; i++){  
    sum += i;  
}
```

C Program (equivalent)

```
int i = 0;  
int sum = 0;  
  
while (i < 10) {  
    sum += i;  
    i++;  
}
```

Implementation 2a:

```
        MOV     r0, #0    % sum = 0  
        MOV     r1, #0    % i = 0  
        B       check  
loop:  
        ADD     r0, r0, r1 % sum += i  
        ADD     r1, r1, #1 % i++  
Check:  CMP     r1, #10   % check whether i < 10  
        BLT     loop     % loop if i less than 10.
```

For Loop

C Program

```
int i;  
int sum = 0;  
for(i = 0; i < 10; i++){  
    sum += i;  
}
```

C Program (equivalent)

```
int i = 0;  
int sum = 0;  
  
do {  
    sum += i;  
    i++;  
} while (i < 10);
```

Implementation 2b:

```
MOV     r0, #0           % sum = 0  
MOV     r1, #0           % i = 0  
%B      check Deleted  
  
Loop:  
ADD r0, r0, r1           % sum += i  
ADD r1, r1, #1           % i++  
CMP r1, #10              % check whether i < 10  
BLT loop                 % loop if i less than 10.
```



Explanations for 2a and 2b

- ▶ 2a and 2b implement two different loop structures:
 - ▶ Version with “B check” is a pre-test loop (while/for): it tests $i < 10$ before the first iteration, so the body may execute zero times if the condition is false initially
 - ▶ Version without “B check” is a post-test loop (do-while): it executes the body once before testing, then repeats while $i < 10$
- ▶ Because i starts at 0 and the condition is $i < 10$, and loop iterates from $i=0$ to $i=9$, even though the control-flow order differs. If the initial condition were false, only the pre-test version would skip the loop entirely.

For Loop

C Program

```
int i;  
int sum = 0;  
for(i = 0; i < 10; i++){  
    sum += i;  
}
```

C Program (equivalent)

```
int sum = 0;    // r0  
int count = 10; // r1  
int i = 0;      // r2  
  
while (count != 0) {  
    sum += i;  
    i += 1;  
    count -= 1;  
}
```

Implementation 3 (Count-down with SUBS/BNE):

MOV	r0, #0	% sum = 0
MOV	r1, #10	% loop count = 10
MOV	r2, #0	% i = 0
loop:		
ADD	r0, r0, r2	% sum += i
ADD	r2, r2, #1	% i++
SUBS	r1, r1, #1	% --count, set flags
BNE	loop	% repeat until loop
count==0		

For Loop

C Program

```
int i;  
int sum = 0;  
for(i = 0; i < 10; i++){  
    sum += i;  
}
```

C Program (equivalent)

```
int i = 0;  
int sum = 0;  
  
while (i < 10) {  
    sum += i;  
    i++;  
}
```

Implementation 4 (Use conditional execution):

MOV	r0, #0	% sum = 0
MOV	r1, #0	% i = 0
loop:		
CMP	r1, #10	% set flags from i-10
ADDLT	r0, r0, r1	% if i<10: sum += i
ADDLT	r1, r1, #1	% if i<10: i++
BLT	loop	% if i<10: loop

Condition Codes

- ▶ The possible condition codes are listed below:

Suffix	Description	Flags tested
EQ	Equal	Z=1
NE	Not equal	Z=0
CS/HS	Unsigned higher or same	C=1
CC/LO	Unsigned lower	C=0
MI	Negative	N=1
PL	Positive or Zero	N=0
VS	Overflow	V=1
VC	No overflow	V=0
HI	Unsigned higher	C=1 & Z=0
LS	Unsigned lower or same	C=0 or Z=1
GE	Signed Greater or equal	N=V
LT	Signed Less than	N!=V
GT	Signed Greater than	Z=0 & N=V
LE	Signed Less than or equal	Z=1 or N!=V
AL	Always	

Note AL is the default and does not need to be specified



Conditional Execution

Add instruction	Condition	Flag tested
ADDEQ r3, r2, r1	Add if EQual	Add if Z = 1
ADDNE r3, r2, r1	Add if Not Equal	Add if Z = 0
ADDHS r3, r2, r1	Add if Unsigned Higher or Same	Add if C = 1
ADDLO r3, r2, r1	Add if Unsigned LOwer	Add if C = 0
ADDMI r3, r2, r1	Add if Minus (Negative)	Add if N = 1
ADDPL r3, r2, r1	Add if PPlus (Positive or Zero)	Add if N = 0
ADDVS r3, r2, r1	Add if oVerflow Set	Add if V = 1
ADDVC r3, r2, r1	Add if oVerflow Clear	Add if V = 0
ADDHI r3, r2, r1	Add if Unsigned HIgher	Add if C = 1 & Z = 0
ADDLS r3, r2, r1	Add if Unsigned Lower or Same	Add if C = 0 or Z = 1
ADDGE r3, r2, r1	Add if Signed Greater or Equal	Add if N = V
ADDLT r3, r2, r1	Add if Signed Less Than	Add if N != V
ADDGT r3, r2, r1	Add if Signed Greater Than	Add if Z = 0 & N = V
ADDLE r3, r2, r1	Add if Signed Less than or Equal	Add if Z = 1 or N = !V

Conditional Execution Examples

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>//y is a signed integer if (a <= 0) y = -1; else y = 1;</pre>	<pre>% r0 = a, r1 = y CMP r0, #0 MOVLE r1, #-1 ; executed if LE MOVGT r1, #1 ; executed if GT</pre>
<pre>if (a==1 a==7 a==11) y = 1; else y = -1;</pre>	<pre>CMP r0, #1 CMPNE r0, #7 ; executed if r0 != 1 CMPNE r0, #11 ; executed if r0 != 7 MOVEQ r1, #1 MOVNE r1, #-1</pre>
<pre>// x is a signed integer if(x <= 20 x >= 25){ a = 1; }</pre>	<pre>; r0 = x, r1 = a CMP r0, #20 ; compare x and 20 MOVLE r1, #1 ; a=1 if less or equal CMP r0, #25 ; CMP if greater than MOVGE r1, #1 ; a=1 if greater or equal</pre>

LE: Signed Less than or Equal

NE: Not Equal

GT: Signed Greater Than

EQ: Equal



Explanations for Compound Boolean Expression

- ▶ Explanations for compound condition
 - ▶ `CMP r0, #1`
 - ▶ `CMPNE r0, #7` ; executed if `r0 != 1`
 - ▶ `CMPNE r0, #11` ; executed if `r0 != 7`
 - ▶ `MOVEQ r1, #1`
 - ▶ `MOVNE r1, #-1`
- ▶ `CMP r0, #1` compares `a` with `1` and sets `Z=1` if equal, else `Z=0`.
- ▶ `CMPNE r0, #7` runs only if the previous compare was not equal, and if it runs, it refreshes the flags by comparing `a` with `7`.
- ▶ `CMPNE r0, #11` runs only if `a` was not `1` and not `7`, and if it runs, it compares `a` with `11` to set `Z` accordingly.
- ▶ `MOVEQ r1, #1` executes only when `Z=1` from any of the comparisons, so `y` becomes `1` if `a` matched `1`, `7`, or `11`.
- ▶ `MOVNE r1, #-1` executes only when `Z=0` after all relevant compares, so `y` becomes `-1` when none of the values matched.

Branching vs. Conditional Execution

C Program§	Assembly Program 1	Assembly Program 2
// x in r0, y in r1 if (x + y < 0) x = 0; else x = 1;	ADD ^S r0, r0, r1 B ^{PL} PosOrZ MOV r0, #0 B done PosOrZ MOV r0, #1 done	ADD ^S r0, r0, r1 ; r0 = x + y, setting CCs MOV ^{MI} r0, #0 ; return 0 if n bit = 1 MOV ^{PL} r0, #1 ; return 1 if n bit = 0

BPL PosOrZ: Branch to PosOrZ if condition PL is true (N == 0 indicating Positive or Zero) for ADDS r0, r0, r1

MOVPL r0, #1: conditional move that executes only when condition PL is true

MOVMI r0, #0: conditional move that executes only when condition MI (N == 1 indicating Negative) is true

Combination

Instruction	Operands	Brief description
CBZ	Rn, label	Compare and Branch if Zero
CBNZ	Rn, label	Compare and Branch if Non Zero

- ▶ Except that it does not change the status flags, **CBZ Rn, label** is equivalent to:
 CMP Rn, #0
 BEQ label
- ▶ Except that it does not change the status flags, **CBNZ Rn, label** is equivalent to:
 CMP Rn, #0
 BNE label

Break vs. Continue

Example code for break	Example code for continue
<pre>for(int i = 0; i < 5; i++){ if (i == 2) break; printf("%d, ", i) }</pre>	<pre>for(int i = 0; i < 5; i++){ if (i == 2) continue; printf("%d, ", i) }</pre>
Output: 0, 1	Output: 0, 1, 3, 4

Break Example

C Program	Assembly Program 1	Assembly Program 2
<pre>// Find string length char str[] = "hello"; int len = 0; for(; ;) { if (*str == '\0') break; str++; len++; }</pre>	<pre>;r0 = string memory address ;r1 = string length ADR r0, str MOV r1, #0 Loop: LDRB r2, [r0] CBNZ r2, notZero B endloop notZero: ADD r0, r0, #1 ; str++ ADD r1, r1, #1 ; len++ B loop endloop:</pre>	<pre>;r0 = string memory address ;r1 = string length ADR r0, str MOV r1, #0 Loop: LDRB r2, [r0] CBZ r2, endloop ADD r0, r0, #1 ADD r1, r1, #1 B loop endloop:</pre>

Break and Continue Example

C Program	Assembly Program
<pre>// Count characters that are not 'l' until the null terminator char str[] = "hello"; int count = 0; for (; ;) { if (*str == '\0') break; if (*str == 'l') continue; count++; str++; }</pre>	<pre>; r0 = string address (str) ; r1 = count = 0 ADR r0, str MOV r1, #0 Loop: LDRB r2, [r0] CBZ r2, endloop ; if '\0' => break CMP r2, #'l' ; if char == 'l' BEQ contLoop ; continue and skip count++ ADD r1, r1, #1 ; count++ contLoop: ADD r0, r0, #1 ; str++ B loop endloop:</pre>

IT (If-Then) instruction

- ▶ "IT" (If-Then) instruction in the ARM Thumb-2 instruction set (16 bits) allows conditional execution of up to four instructions based on a condition flag (like EQ, NE, etc.).
- ▶ **IT{x{y{z}}} {cond}**, where x, y, and z specify the existence of the optional second, third, and fourth conditional instruction respectively. x, y, and z are either **T** (Then) or **E** (Else). T = execute the following instruction if condition is True; E = execute the following instruction if condition is False
 - ▶ IT — 1 following instruction (If)
 - ▶ ITT — 2 following instructions (If-Then)
 - ▶ ITE — 2 following instructions (If-Else)
 - ▶ ITTE, ITEEE, etc. — up to 4 instructions total

You do not need to write IT instructions in your code. The assembler generates them for you automatically according to the conditions specified.

ITTE NE ; If-Then-Then-Else
ANDNE r0,r0,r1 ; executed if Not Equal
ADDNE r2,r2,#1 ; executed if Not Equal
MOVEQ r2,r3 ; executed if Equal

ITT EQ ; Executes both instructions only if Equal condition is true
MOVEQ r0,r1
ADDEQ r0,r0,#1

ITT EQ ; Executes both instructions only if Equal condition is true
MOVEQ r0,r1
BEQ dloop ; branch at end of IT block is permitted

ITT AL ; AL (Always) condition executes two 16-bit instructions unconditionally; the last ADD is outside the IT block.
ADDAL r0,r0,r1 ; 16-bit ADD, not ADDS
SUBAL r2,r2,#1 ; 16-bit SUB, not SUB
ADD r0,r0,r1 ; expands into 32-bit ADD, and is not in IT block

Summary: Condition Codes

Suffix	Description	Flags tested
EQ	E Qual	Z=1
NE	N ot E qual	Z=0
CS/HS	Unsigned H igher or S ame	C=1
CC/LO	Unsigned L ower	C=0
MI	M Inus (Negative)	N=1
PL	P Lus (Positive or Zero)	N=0
VS	o V erflow S et	V=1
VC	o V erflow C leared	V=0
HI	Unsigned H Igher	C=1 & Z=0
LS	Unsigned L ower or S ame	C=0 or Z=1
GE	Signed G reater or E qual	N=V
LT	Signed L ess T han	N!=V
GT	Signed G reater T han	Z=0 & N=V
LE	Signed L ess than or E qual	Z=1 or N!=V
AL	A Lways	

Note AL is the default and does not need to be specified

Summary: Branch Instructions

	Instruction	Description	Flags tested
Unconditional Branch	B <i>Label</i>	Branch to label	
Conditional Branch	BEQ <i>Label</i>	Branch if E Qual	Z = 1
	BNE <i>Label</i>	Branch if N ot E qual	Z = 0
	BCS/BHS <i>Label</i>	Branch if unsigned H igher or S ame	C = 1
	BCC/BLO <i>Label</i>	Branch if unsigned L Ower	C = 0
	BMI <i>Label</i>	Branch if M inus (Negative)	N = 1
	BPL <i>Label</i>	Branch if P Lus (Positive or Zero)	N = 0
	BVS <i>Label</i>	Branch if o V erflow S et	V = 1
	BVC <i>Label</i>	Branch if o V erflow C lear	V = 0
	BHI <i>Label</i>	Branch if unsigned H Igher	C = 1 & Z = 0
	BLS <i>Label</i>	Branch if unsigned L ower or S ame	C = 0 or Z = 1
	BGE <i>Label</i>	Branch if signed G reater or E qual	N = V
	BLT <i>Label</i>	Branch if signed L ess T han	N != V
	BGT <i>Label</i>	Branch if signed G reater T han	Z = 0 & N = V
	BLE <i>Label</i>	Branch if signed L ess than or E qual	Z = 1 or N = ! V

Summary: Conditionally Executed

Add instruction	Condition	Flag tested
ADDEQ r3, r2, r1	Add if EQual	Add if Z = 1
ADDNE r3, r2, r1	Add if Not Equal	Add if Z = 0
ADDHS r3, r2, r1	Add if Unsigned Higher or Same	Add if C = 1
ADDLO r3, r2, r1	Add if Unsigned LOwer	Add if C = 0
ADDMI r3, r2, r1	Add if Minus (Negative)	Add if N = 1
ADDPL r3, r2, r1	Add if PPlus (Positive or Zero)	Add if N = 0
ADDVS r3, r2, r1	Add if oVerflow Set	Add if V = 1
ADDVC r3, r2, r1	Add if oVerflow Clear	Add if V = 0
ADDHI r3, r2, r1	Add if Unsigned HIgher	Add if C = 1 & Z = 0
ADDLS r3, r2, r1	Add if Unsigned Lower or Same	Add if C = 0 or Z = 1
ADDGE r3, r2, r1	Add if Signed Greater or Equal	Add if N = V
ADDLT r3, r2, r1	Add if Signed Less Than	Add if N != V
ADDGT r3, r2, r1	Add if Signed Greater Than	Add if Z = 0 & N = V
ADDLE r3, r2, r1	Add if Signed Less than or Equal	Add if Z = 1 or N = !V

References

- ▶ Lecture 27. Branch instructions

- ▶ https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_QKD7fIcmRI&list=PLRJhV4hUhlymmp5CCeIFPyxbknsdcXCc8&index=27

- ▶ Lecture 28. Conditional Execution

- ▶ <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9hlxG8L5-G4&list=PLRJhV4hUhlymmp5CCeIFPyxbknsdcXCc8&index=28>